Offices and commercial premises — renovation while business continues

Can an office remain open during renovation?

It depends on work segregation, noise, dust, access, escape routes and shared services. A phasing and safety plan must protect workers and visitors.

Can office toilets be renovated without closing the whole business?

It may be possible with another toilet available, isolation measures and coordinated interruptions. Assess accessibility and hygiene obligations; do not leave facilities available if disconnected.

What should be checked before replacing a shop floor?

Substrate strength and condition, expected traffic, slip resistance, thresholds, ramps, accessibility and business hours. Select the finish for actual loads and conditions.

How can dust near computers be avoided?

Isolate the work area, protect equipment, plan shutdowns and specialist cleaning as needed. Simple vacuuming at day’s end does not replace adequate physical isolation.

What should be reviewed when changing an office layout?

Escape routes, fire compartmentation, services, lighting, ventilation, workstations and accessibility. Changing the layout involves more than plasterboard partitions.

Can work be carried out at night?

It depends on municipal regulations, the owners’ association, noise, working conditions and agreement. Do not promise night work without checking authorisation and availability.

What if the premises have old services?

Before adding uses or loads, verify existing service capacity, documentation and protection. New equipment may require adaptations that cannot be inferred from its advertised power rating.

What is the difference between minor work and change of use?

Change of use may require planning, safety, accessibility and services analysis beyond a simple finish repair. Classification requires reviewing local regulations and scope.

How can work be organised without blocking the entrance?

Plan alternative access, fencing, signage, delivery logistics and escape routes. Public circulation takes priority over execution convenience.

What does handover of renovated premises require?

Checking services, finishes, cleaning, technical documentation where appropriate and outstanding items. Ensure business opening is not confused with administrative completion.

Case O-11 — Office with two toilets

Hypothetical assessment case, not completed work or a service committed to by Riansares 4R.

Situation: One is renovated while the other remains operational.

Checks: Capacity, accessibility, closures and shared interruptions.

Possible scope: Phases and physical barriers.

Decision criterion: Do not accidentally isolate both toilets' services.

Evidence to retain: Interruption record, tests and reopening.

Case O-12 — Shop with worn flooring

Hypothetical assessment case, not completed work or a service committed to by Riansares 4R.

Situation: Slips occur on a circulation surface.

Checks: Substrate condition, moisture and new flooring performance.

Possible scope: Repair compatible with traffic, accessibility and escape routes.

Decision criterion: Appearance must not take precedence over safety.

Evidence to retain: Technical data sheet and acceptance record.

Industry references and scope

- CTE_SUA.
- CTE_HS.

The references provide general context and do not establish that Riansares 4R has carried out work. Technical requirements must be verified for the applicable type of intervention and jurisdiction.